

DICK'S CERTASURV DRIVE AND CHAT GUIDE

Company email, shared drive, parcel research, DWG and points, Drive for desktop, and Google Chat

Start Here

- 1 Sign in** - Use the company Google account before opening Drive, Gmail, or Chat.
- 2 Open the shared drive** - In Google Drive, choose Shared drives, then open CERTASURV_PROJECT DRIVE.
- 3 Match the project** - Open the project folder that matches both the SSD job number and the address or project name.
- 4 Work inside the inner SSD folder** - Use the numbered workflow folders. Courthouse research is in 02; office drafting is in 04.

The Two Paths Used Most

Tax map parcel research

CERTASURV_PROJECT DRIVE > [PROJECT] > SSD > 02_COURTHOUSE_RESEARCH > parcels
> [TAX MAP NUMBER]

Use for courthouse screenshots, deeds, plats, tax maps, GIS images, and related parcel material.

DWG and points

CERTASURV_PROJECT DRIVE > [PROJECT] > SSD > 04_OFFICE_DRAFTING > 02_BASE_FILES

Use for the CAD drawing and the matching points file used for office work.

Folder correction

The live drive does **not** use 04 Courthouse > Files > Parcels. Use 02_COURTHOUSE_RESEARCH > parcels inside the selected project.

OPEN COMPANY EMAIL

mail.google.com

OPEN PROJECT DRIVE

project drive link

OPEN GOOGLE CHAT

chat.google.com

1. How The Shared Drive Is Organized

Start at the shared drive, choose the correct project, then use the same numbered workflow folders inside that project.

Shared drive name

CERTASURV_PROJECT DRIVE

Direct link: <https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/0ALDrNUPuW8smUk9PVA>

At the root of the shared drive, most active jobs are project folders named with an SSD job number and a location. Examples include SSD-11643-RT35 and SSD-11641 - WINFIELD. The drive also contains system folders such as TEMPLATE, ARCHIVE, 01FORMS, ESTIMATES, and 00_CERTASURV_COMMAND_CENTER.

Standard Project Folder Tree

Open folders in this order

CERTASURV_PROJECT DRIVE > [SSD-##### - PROJECT NAME OR ADDRESS] > SSD
 > 01_INTAKE_SCOPE > 02_COURTHOUSE_RESEARCH > 03_FIELD_WORK
 > 04_OFFICE_DRAFTING > 05_REVIEW_QC > 06_DELIVERABLES

Folder	Use
01_INTAKE_SCOPE	Client intake, job scope, proposal information, and starting documents.
02_COURTHOUSE_RESEARCH	Deeds, plats, tax maps, screenshots, parcel folders, and the master research log.
03_FIELD_WORK	Crew instructions, raw field data, photos, sketches, line marking, control, and stakeout files.
04_OFFICE_DRAFTING	Office notes, base files, DWG drawings, points, and exhibit PDFs.
05_REVIEW_QC	Review and quality-control work before delivery.
06_DELIVERABLES	Drafts and final deliverables.

Rule

For normal job work, open the correct SSD project folder. Do not work from TEMPLATE or ARCHIVE unless a supervisor specifically tells you to do so.

2. Find Courthouse And Parcel Files

Parcel research is organized inside each project. Parcel folders are commonly named by the full tax map number.

Correct courthouse path

```
CERTASURV_PROJECT_DRIVE > [PROJECT] > SSD > 02_COURTHOUSE_RESEARCH > parcels  
> [TAX_MAP_NUMBER]
```

Step By Step

- 1** Open **CERTASURV_PROJECT_DRIVE** - Use Shared drives in Google Drive, or use the direct link in this guide.
- 2** Open the **project folder** - Match both the SSD job number and the project name or address.
- 3** Open the **inner SSD folder** - This is the standard working folder inside the project.
- 4** Open **02_COURTHOUSE_RESEARCH** - This is the courthouse, deed, plat, tax map, and parcel research area.
- 5** Open **parcels** - In populated projects, this folder contains separate folders for individual parcels.
- 6** Open the **exact tax map number** - Match the complete number, including leading zeros and the final suffix.

Example parcel folder name

28-11-0050-0126-0000

A parcel folder may contain courthouse screenshots, tax-map images, GIS images, deeds, plats, and related research.

Useful Courthouse Folders

- 00_MASTER_RESEARCH_LOG - overall research notes and tracking for the project.
- parcels - individual parcel folders, normally named by tax map number.
- plats - plat images or grouped plat material when that folder is present.

Search Tips

- Search the shared drive using the full SSD job number when you cannot find the project.
- Search using the complete tax map number when a parcel folder is hard to spot.
- Double-check the project address before opening or downloading files from a similar job.

Note

A new or lightly researched project may not have a parcels folder yet. That usually means the parcel research has not been added or the material is still stored directly in 02_COURTHOUSE_RESEARCH.

3. Get The DWG And Points File

The drawing and point data are stored in the office-drafting base-files folder for the selected project.

Correct DWG and points path

CERTASURV_PROJECT DRIVE > [PROJECT] > SSD > 04_OFFICE_DRAFTING > 02_BASE_FILES

Type	Typical extension	Meaning
Drawing	.dwg	CAD drawing used by AutoCAD or compatible drafting software.
Points	.csv or .txt	Survey point data. Populated base-files folders commonly include a CSV points file.

Download From The Browser

- 1** **Open 02_BASE_FILES** - Confirm the folder is inside the correct project.
- 2** **Download the DWG** - Right-click the drawing file and choose Download.
- 3** **Download the points file** - Download the CSV, TXT, or other points file that belongs with the drawing.
- 4** **Save them together** - Put both files in the same local job folder on the computer.
- 5** **Open the local copies** - Use the approved CAD or point-processing software after the download finishes.

Before opening or sending, confirm	
☐ Correct SSD job number	☐ Correct project name or address
☐ Latest intended DWG version	☐ Matching points file downloaded
☐ Local copies saved together	☐ Source files left in place in Drive

Protect the source files

Download a copy. Do not move, rename, replace, or delete shared Drive files unless a supervisor specifically directs you to do that. When several versions exist, confirm which version is current before working.

4. Install And Use Drive For Desktop

Drive for desktop puts Google Drive in Windows File Explorer or macOS Finder. The browser is still the safest choice for a one-time download.

OPEN DRIVE IN BROWSER
drive.google.com

OPEN PROJECT DRIVE
project drive link

**DOWNLOAD DRIVE FOR
DESKTOP**
official download page

Install And Sign In

- 1** **Open the official download page** - Use the Download Drive for desktop button above.
- 2** **Run the installer** - On Windows, open GoogleDriveSetup.exe. On macOS, open GoogleDrive.dmg.
- 3** **Follow the prompts** - Let the installer finish, then open Google Drive for desktop.
- 4** **Sign in with company email** - Use the same company Google account that has access to the shared drive.
- 5** **Open Shared drives** - In File Explorer or Finder, open Google Drive, then Shared drives.
- 6** **Open CERTASURV_PROJECT DRIVE** - Choose the project, open SSD, and use the same numbered folders shown in this guide.

What the path looks like on the computer

Google Drive > Shared drives > CERTASURV_PROJECT DRIVE > [PROJECT] > SSD > ...

Best Practice For DWG Work

- Use Drive for desktop to find the file, but make a local working copy when directed by the office workflow.
- Keep the DWG and its points file together in the same local job folder.
- Do not drag shared-drive folders to another location. Dragging can move them for everyone if you have permission.
- When a file is only online, allow it to finish downloading before opening it in CAD software.

Simple option

For a one-time download, the browser method is usually safest: open Drive, right-click the file, choose Download, and save it locally.

5. Install Google Chat And Solve Common Problems

Google Chat can be used in the browser or installed from Chrome as a desktop web app.

OPEN GOOGLE CHAT

chat.google.com

OFFICIAL CHAT INSTALL GUIDE

Google Chat Help

OPEN COMPANY EMAIL

mail.google.com

Install Google Chat On The Computer

- 1** **Open Google Chrome** - The desktop Chat app is installed through Chrome.
- 2** **Go to chat.google.com** - Sign in with the company Google account.
- 3** **Click the Install icon** - Use the install icon at the right side of Chrome's address bar.
- 4** **If the icon is not visible** - Open Chrome's menu and choose Install Google Chat.
- 5** **Open Chat later** - On Windows, open Start and choose Chat. On a Mac, open it from Applications.

Send A Drive File In Google Chat

- In Drive, open the correct project and locate the file or folder.
- Use Copy link or paste the Drive link into Chat. Do not change sharing permissions unless authorized.
- Include the SSD job number, project name, and a short description so the recipient knows exactly what the link is.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Shared drive is missing	Check the profile picture and switch to the company Google account. If it is still missing, access must be granted by the Drive administrator.
Project is hard to find	Search the full SSD job number first. Then confirm the project name or address.
DWG will not open in Drive	Download it and open the local copy in AutoCAD or the approved CAD program.
No Download option	You may not have download permission. Ask a supervisor or Drive administrator.
Chat install icon is missing	Make sure Chat is open in Chrome and you are signed in. Use Chrome menu > Install Google Chat.

Final reminder

Use the correct company account, confirm the SSD job number, and download copies instead of moving shared files.
Never rename, move, replace, or delete a shared folder unless a supervisor tells you to do so.

Official help checked July 22, 2026: [Drive for desktop help](#) and [Google Chat install help](#).